II. Secret Procedure

Secret procedure is adopted to decide certain vital issues. It is a popular voting method that could maintain the secrecy of the voter.

a) By Ballot



Under this system, ballot paper bearing serial number is given to the members to record their opinion by marking with the symbol or Shareholders have to cast their vote in a secret chamber and put the ballot paper into the ballot box. The chairman opens the ballot box in the presence of tellers or scrutinizers and counts the votes. He rejects the defective or wrongly marked ballot papers. The votes are counted and the results are announced.

b) Postal Ballot



Big companies or big associations having members scattered all over the country follow this method of voting. Under this method serially numbered ballot papers are sent by post in sealed covers to the members,who, living at a distant place, are unable to attend the meeting physically. The members or voters fill in the ballot papers and return them in sealed covers which are opened when the ballot box is opened for counting the votes.

QUORUM

There is another requirement of quorum. A single person does not contain a meeting so it has to be seen that the required number of people are present. Requisite number of person at the meeting is called as quorum.

PROXY

Proxy means a person being the representative of a shareholder at the meeting of the company who may be described as his agent to carry out which the shareholder has himself decided upon. Proxy can be present at the meeting and he cannot vote.

Key Words

Secretary Meetings Committee
Motion Resolution

For Future learning

1. Study the websites which are related to company functions www.bseindia.com

Case Study

1. Mr R, as the secretary of the Muraliviki Co., signed a letter to its bank, forwarding a 'resolution' of the board of directors. The resolution named three directors and instructed the bank to pay cheques signed by any two of them and countersigned by the secretary. Specimen signatures were attached. The instruction was entirely in accordance with the company's memorandum and articles. However, there had never been any proper appointment of directors or a secretary by the company. Those who had formed the company had assumed their roles. Following the letter, the bank had honoured cheques in accordance with the instructions contained in the letter. The question was, whether, the company was bound by the cheques. Comment.

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